Unit V: Creating and Managing Presentations.

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This unit focuses on the practical aspects of using presentation software like Microsoft PowerPoint, Google Slides, or LibreOffice Impress to create impactful visual aids for conveying information effectively. It covers everything from starting a presentation to advanced features like transitions and printing.

Creating Presentations: Using Blank Presentation Option

Starting with a blank presentation gives you complete control over the design and layout, allowing for maximum customization. It's ideal when you want to build a presentation from scratch or have a very specific design in mind that isn't covered by existing templates.

Steps to Create a Presentation Using a Blank Presentation:

1. **Open Presentation Software**: Launch your chosen presentation software (e.g., Microsoft PowerPoint).
2. **Select "Blank Presentation"**:
    - Upon opening, most software will present you with a start screen. Look for an option like "**Blank Presentation**," "**New Presentation**," or "**Empty Presentation**."
    - Alternatively, if the software opens directly to an existing presentation or template gallery, go to `File` > `New` > `Blank Presentation`.
3. **Default Slide Layout**: When you choose a blank presentation, you'll typically be presented with a **Title Slide** layout by default. This layout usually has placeholders for a title and a subtitle.
4. **Add Content to the First Slide**:
    - Click on the "**Click to add title**" placeholder and type your presentation's main title.
    - Click on the "**Click to add subtitle**" placeholder and type your name, the date, or a brief introductory statement.
5. **Add New Slides**: To expand your presentation, you'll need to add more slides.
    - Go to the `Home` tab on the ribbon.
    - In the `Slides` group, click the **`New Slide`** button.
    - A dropdown menu will appear, showing various **slide layouts** (e.g., Title and Content, Section Header, Two Content, Comparison, Title Only, Blank, etc.). Choose the layout that best suits the content you plan to put on that slide.
    - Alternatively, you can right-click on an existing slide thumbnail in the left-hand `Slides/Outline Pane` and select `New Slide`.
6. **Populate New Slides**:
    - For each new slide, click on the **placeholders** (e.g., "Click to add title," "Click to add text") and enter your content.

    - Placeholders are pre-formatted boxes for specific types of content (text, images, charts, tables, media).
    - If you choose a "Content" layout, you'll often see icons within the content placeholder allowing you to quickly insert tables, charts, SmartArt, pictures, online pictures, or video.
7. **Save Your Presentation**:
    - It's crucial to save your work frequently.
    - Go to `File` > `Save` or `File` > `Save As` (for the first time or to save a new version).
    - Choose a location (e.g., Desktop, Documents, OneDrive).
    - Give your presentation a meaningful `File name` (e.g., "Office Automation Unit V Notes.pptx").
    - Click `Save`.

Advantages of using a Blank Presentation:

- **Complete Creative Freedom**: You're not restricted by existing color schemes, fonts, or placeholder positions of templates.
- **Lean and Clean**: No unnecessary elements or pre-defined content to delete.
- **Building Custom Templates**: If you intend to create your own unique presentation design from scratch, starting blank is the way to go. You can then save your design as a custom template for future use.

Disadvantages:

- **Time-Consuming**: Requires more effort and design decisions upfront.
- **Requires Design Knowledge**: You need a good understanding of visual design principles to make it look professional.

Creating Presentations: Using Design Template

Design templates provide a pre-designed framework for your presentation, including color schemes, fonts, background styles, and placeholder layouts. They save time and ensure a consistent, professional look across all your slides.

Steps to Create a Presentation Using a Design Template:

1. **Open Presentation Software**: Launch your chosen presentation software.
2. **Select a Template**:
    - From the start screen (when opening the software), you'll often see a gallery of built-in templates. Browse through them to find one that suits your topic or organization's branding.
    - If you're already in a presentation, go to `File` > `New`. This will show you the available templates.
    - You can also search for online templates if connected to the internet.
3. **Create from Template**: Click on the desired template and then click `Create` or `Download` (if it's an online template).
4. **Populate Slides**: The template will open with pre-defined slide layouts and designs.

    - Click on the existing placeholders to add your titles, text, images, charts, etc.
    - The template often includes example slides or guidance on how to use specific layouts.
5. **Add New Slides with Template Layouts**: When you add new slides using `New Slide`, the available layouts will automatically adopt the chosen template's design.
    - Select a layout that fits your content and proceed to fill the placeholders.
6. **Modify Design (Optional but Recommended)**:
    - Even with a template, you can customize it further.
    - Go to the `Design` tab on the ribbon.
    - In the `Themes` group, you can change the overall theme, colors, fonts, and background styles.
    - In the `Variants` group, you can choose different color schemes or font sets within the same theme.
    - **Slide Master View**: For deeper customization of the template itself (e.g., changing the position of a logo on all slides, modifying all heading fonts at once), you'd use the `Slide Master View` (`View` tab > `Slide Master`). Any changes here apply to all slides based on that master.
7. **Save Your Presentation**: Save your work regularly.

Advantages of using Design Templates:

- **Time-Saving**: Quickly get a professional-looking presentation without extensive design effort.
- **Consistency**: Ensures a uniform look and feel across all slides, enhancing professionalism.
- **Professional Appearance**: Designed by professionals, often adhering to good design principles.
- **Focus on Content**: Allows you to concentrate more on the message rather than the aesthetics.

Disadvantages:

- **Less Customization**: While modifiable, you start with a predefined structure which might limit extreme customization unless you delve into Slide Master.
- **Generic Look**: If overused, your presentation might look similar to others using the same template.

Adding Slides

Adding new slides is fundamental to building the content of your presentation.

Methods to Add a Slide:

1. **Using the Ribbon (New Slide Button)**:
    - Select the slide *after which* you want to add a new slide in the `Slides/Outline Pane` on the left.
    - Go to the `Home` tab.

    - In the `Slides` group, click the **`New Slide`** button. This will usually insert a new slide with the default "Title and Content" layout or the most recently used layout.
    - Alternatively, click the **down arrow** next to the `New Slide` button to open a gallery of slide layouts. Choose the specific layout you need (e.g., "Title Only," "Two Content," "Blank").
2. **Right-Clicking in the Slides/Outline Pane**:
    - Right-click on a slide thumbnail in the left-hand `Slides/Outline Pane`.
    - From the context menu, select **`New Slide`**. This will insert a new slide with the default layout.
    - You can also right-click and choose `Duplicate Slide` to create an exact copy of the selected slide, which is useful if you want to reuse its layout and some content.
3. **Using Keyboard Shortcut**:
    - `Ctrl + M` (Windows) or `Cmd + Shift + N` (Mac) is the universal shortcut to add a new slide with the default layout.

Choosing Slide Layouts:

- When you add a new slide, it's crucial to select the appropriate **slide layout**.
- Layouts define the arrangement of placeholders for titles, text, images, charts, etc.
- **To change a slide's layout after creation**: Select the slide, go to the `Home` tab > `Slides` group > `Layout`, and choose a different layout. The content you've already added will attempt to fit into the new placeholders.

Common Slide Layouts:

- **Title Slide**: For the very first slide, with main title and subtitle.
- **Title and Content**: Most common, with a title and a content placeholder for text, lists, charts, etc.
- **Section Header**: To introduce a new section of your presentation.
- **Two Content**: For comparing two items side-by-side or presenting two related points.
- **Comparison**: Similar to Two Content but often includes a section title and comparison placeholders.
- **Title Only**: A slide with just a title placeholder, leaving the rest blank for images or custom design.
- **Blank**: Completely empty, ideal for complex custom designs or full-bleed images.
- **Content with Caption**: Content placeholder with a smaller text box for a caption.
- **Picture with Caption**: Placeholder for an image and a text box for its caption.

Deleting a Slide

Deleting slides helps in streamlining your presentation and removing irrelevant content.

Steps to Delete a Slide:

1. **Select the Slide(s)**:

    - In the `Slides/Outline Pane` on the left, click on the thumbnail of the slide you want to delete.
    - To select multiple non-contiguous slides, hold down `Ctrl` (Windows) or `Cmd` (Mac) and click on each slide.
    - To select a contiguous block of slides, click the first slide, then hold `Shift` and click the last slide in the block.
2. **Delete Action**:
    - **Press `Delete` key**: With the slide(s) selected, press the `Delete` key on your keyboard.
    - **Right-Click**: Right-click on the selected slide(s) in the `Slides/Outline Pane` and choose `Delete Slide` from the context menu.

Important Note: Once a slide is deleted, it's removed from the presentation. You can usually undo this action immediately after deletion (`Ctrl+Z` or the `Undo` button), but it's good practice to be sure before deleting.

Importing Images from Outside

Visuals are crucial for engaging presentations. Importing images from external sources is a common task.

Steps to Import Images:

1. **Select the Slide**: Navigate to the slide where you want to insert the image.
2. **Access Insert Picture Option**:
    - Go to the `Insert` tab on the ribbon.
    - In the `Images` (or `Illustrations`) group, click on the `Pictures` button.
3. **Choose Image Source**: You'll usually have options like:
    - **`This Device` / `From File`**: To insert an image saved on your computer or a connected drive. This is the most common method for importing your own photos or graphics.
        - A dialog box will open. Navigate to the folder where your image is saved, select the image file (e.g., .jpg, .png, .gif, .bmp), and click `Insert`.
    - **`Stock Images`**: Accesses a library of high-quality, royalty-free images provided by the software vendor (e.g., Microsoft 365). Requires an internet connection.
    - **`Online Pictures`**: Allows you to search for images online using a search engine like Bing (in PowerPoint). You can filter by license type (e.g., Creative Commons) to ensure you have usage rights. Requires an internet connection.
4. **Position and Resize the Image**:
    - Once inserted, the image will appear on your slide.
    - Click and drag the image to move it to your desired position.
    - Use the **corner selection handles** to resize the image proportionally (drag inwards to make smaller, outwards to make larger). Dragging side handles can distort the image.

    - You can also use the `Height` and `Width` boxes in the `Picture Format` tab for precise sizing, and tick "Lock aspect ratio" to prevent distortion.
5. **Format the Image (Optional)**:
    - When the image is selected, a contextual `Picture Format` tab appears on the ribbon. This tab provides various tools:
        - **Adjust**: Remove background, corrections (brightness, contrast), color adjustments, artistic effects, compress pictures.
        - **Picture Styles**: Apply borders, frames, shadows, reflections.
        - **Arrange**: Bring forward/send backward, align, group, rotate.
        - **Size**: Crop the image, adjust height and width.

Tips for Importing Images:

- **Resolution**: Use high-resolution images for professional presentations, but optimize them to avoid excessively large file sizes.
- **Copyright**: Always be mindful of copyright and licensing when using images from online sources. Use royalty-free images or images with appropriate licenses.
- **Relevance**: Ensure images are directly relevant to your content and enhance understanding, rather than just being decorative.
- **Consistency**: Maintain a consistent visual style throughout your presentation.

Transition and Build Effects

These effects add dynamism and visual interest to your presentation, controlling how slides appear and how elements within a slide appear.

1. Transitions (Slide Transitions)

Transitions are visual effects that occur when you move from one slide to the next during a slide show. They add a professional polish and guide the audience's eye.

- **Applying Transitions**:
    1. Select the slide(s) in the `Slides/Outline Pane` to which you want to apply a transition.
    2. Go to the `Transitions` tab on the ribbon.
    3. Browse through the `Transition to This Slide` gallery. Hovering over an effect usually shows a live preview.
    4. Click on the desired transition (e.g., `Fade`, `Push`, `Wipe`, `Split`, `Reveal`, `Morph`, `Curtains`, `Origami`).
- **Transition Options**:
    - **`Effect Options`**: After selecting a transition, click `Effect Options` (if available for that transition) to customize its direction (e.g., `Push` from `Left`, `Right`, `Top`, `Bottom`).
    - **`Sound`**: You can add a sound effect to play during the transition (generally discouraged as it can be distracting).
    - **`Duration`**: Set how long the transition effect lasts. A shorter duration makes it snappier, a longer one more gradual.

- **`Apply to All`**: Click this button if you want the same transition applied to all slides in your presentation. (Often, a consistent transition is best, but varying them can also be effective if done purposefully).
- **`Advance Slide`**:
  - `On Mouse Click`: The slide advances when you click the mouse (or press Enter/Spacebar). This is the default and recommended for presenter-controlled pace.
  - `After`: Automatically advances the slide after a specified number of seconds. Useful for self-running presentations or kiosks.

Best Practices for Transitions:

- **Keep it Subtle**: Overuse of complex or flashy transitions can be distracting. Simple fades or cuts are often the most professional.
- **Consistency**: Use the same transition throughout the presentation for a cohesive look.
- **Purposeful Variation**: If you do vary transitions, do so for a reason (e.g., a more dramatic transition for a section break).

2. Build Effects (Animations)

Build effects (more commonly called **Animations**) are visual effects that control how individual objects (text, images, shapes, charts) appear, disappear, or move on a slide during a slide show. They are crucial for controlling the flow of information and maintaining audience focus.

- **Applying Animations**:
  1. Select the object on the slide you want to animate (e.g., a text box, an image, a bullet point list).
  2. Go to the `Animations` tab on the ribbon.
  3. In the `Animation` group, open the gallery of animation effects.
     - **Entrance Effects (Green Star)**: How an object appears on the slide (e.g., `Appear`, `Fade`, `Fly In`, `Wipe`, `Zoom`).
     - **Emphasis Effects (Yellow Star)**: Draw attention to an object that is already on the slide (e.g., `Pulse`, `Spin`, `Teeter`, `Grow/Shrink`).
     - **Exit Effects (Red Star)**: How an object leaves the slide (e.g., `Disappear`, `Fade Out`, `Fly Out`, `Zoom Out`).
     - **Motion Paths (Dotted Line)**: Makes an object move along a predefined or custom path (e.g., `Lines`, `Arcs`, `Loops`, `Custom Path`).
  4. Click on the desired animation effect. A number will appear next to the object, indicating its animation order.
- **Animation Pane (Crucial for Control)**:
  - On the `Animations` tab, click `Animation Pane`. This opens a sidebar that lists all animations on the current slide in order.
  - In the `Animation Pane`, you can:
    - **Reorder animations**: Drag and drop animations to change their sequence.
    - **Change Start Option**:

        - **`On Click`**: The animation starts when you click the mouse. (Default, good for presenter control).
        - **`With Previous`**: The animation starts at the same time as the previous animation in the sequence.
        - **`After Previous`**: The animation starts immediately after the previous animation finishes.
    - **Set Duration**: How long the animation effect lasts.
    - **Set Delay**: How long to wait before starting the animation.
    - **Effect Options**: Customize specific aspects of the animation (e.g., `Fly In` from `Top`, `Bottom`, `Left`, `Right`; animate text `By Word` or `By Letter`).
    - **Timing**: More precise control over start, duration, delay, and repeat.
    - **Text Animation**: For bulleted lists, you can choose to animate `All at once`, `By paragraph`, or `By first level paragraphs` (very useful for revealing points one by one).

Best Practices for Animations:

- **Less is More**: Overuse of animations can make a presentation look cluttered and unprofessional. Use them sparingly and purposefully.
- **Control Flow**: Use animations to reveal information gradually, keeping the audience focused on one point at a time. This is especially useful for complex slides or bulleted lists.
- **Consistency**: Stick to a few simple animation types for consistency.
- **Purposeful Use**: Animations should enhance clarity and engagement, not merely be decorative.

Deleting a Slide, Numbering a Slide, Saving Presentation, Closing Presentation, Printing Presentation

These are essential management tasks for your presentation.

Deleting a Slide

(This was already covered in detail above, but reiterating for completeness within this section on slide management.)

- **Steps**:
    1. In the `Slides/Outline Pane` on the left, click the thumbnail of the slide(s) you want to delete.
    2. Press the `Delete` key on your keyboard, OR right-click the selected slide(s) and choose `Delete Slide`.

Numbering a Slide

Slide numbers help your audience keep track of your progress and reference specific slides.

- **Steps to Add Slide Numbers**:
    1. Go to the `Insert` tab on the ribbon.
    2. In the `Text` group, click on `Header & Footer`.
    3. In the `Header and Footer` dialog box that appears:
        - Make sure you are on the `Slide` tab.
        - Check the box next to **`Slide number`**.
        - (Optional) Check `Don't show on title slide` if you don't want the number to appear on your first slide.
        - Click `Apply` to apply to the current slide, or `Apply to All` to apply to all slides in the presentation.
- **Customizing Slide Number Appearance**: The slide number's font, size, and color are usually controlled by the **Slide Master**.
    - Go to `View` tab > `Slide Master`.
    - Select the main `Slide Master` (the largest thumbnail at the top).
    - Find the slide number placeholder (`<#>` or similar) in the footer area.
    - Use the `Home` tab's `Font` group to change its formatting.
    - Close `Slide Master View` to see the changes applied.
- **Starting Slide Number from a Different Value**:

    1. Go to the `Design` tab.
    2. In the `Customize` group, click `Slide Size` > `Custom Slide Size...`.
    3. In the `Slide Size` dialog box, find the `Number slides from:` option and change the starting number. Click `OK`.

Saving Presentation

Saving is critical to prevent data loss and preserve your work.

- **Steps to Save a Presentation**:
    1. **First-time Save (Save As)**:
        - Go to `File` > `Save As`.
        - Choose a location (`Browse`, `OneDrive`, `This PC`).
        - Enter a `File name` (e.g., "Unit 5 Office Automation Notes").
        - Select the `Save as type` (usually `.pptx` for modern PowerPoint presentations). Other options include `.ppt` (older format), `.pdf`, `.ppsx` (PowerPoint Show, opens directly in slide show mode), `.potx` (PowerPoint Template), etc.
        - Click `Save`.
    2. **Subsequent Saves (Save)**:
        - Simply click the `Save` icon on the Quick Access Toolbar (the floppy disk icon), or press `Ctrl + S` (Windows) / `Cmd + S` (Mac).
        - This will overwrite the previously saved version of the file.
- **AutoRecover/AutoSave**: Most modern presentation software includes AutoRecover features that periodically save a temporary copy of your work. In cloud-integrated versions (like Microsoft 365 or Google Slides), `AutoSave` continuously saves your changes to the cloud. Do not rely solely on AutoRecover; regular manual saves are still essential.

Closing Presentation

Closing a presentation removes it from the software's active window without necessarily closing the software itself.

- **Steps to Close a Presentation**:
    1. Go to `File` > `Close`.
    2. If you have unsaved changes, the software will prompt you to `Save`, `Don't Save`, or `Cancel`.
        - `Save`: Saves the changes and closes the presentation.
        - `Don't Save`: Closes the presentation without saving changes.
        - `Cancel`: Returns you to the presentation.
- Alternatively, click the `X` button for the document window (not the application window `X`) if your software supports multiple document interfaces.

Printing Presentation

Printing presentations allows you to create handouts for your audience, speaker notes for yourself, or hard copies for review.

- **Steps to Print a Presentation**:
    1. Go to `File` > `Print` (or `Ctrl + P`). This opens the print preview and options pane.
    2. **Select Printer**: Choose your desired printer from the dropdown list.
    3. **Print Range**:
        - `Print All Slides`: Prints every slide in the presentation.
        - `Print Selection`: Prints only the currently selected slides (if you selected them before opening the print dialog).
        - `Print Current Slide`: Prints only the slide currently visible in the editing window.
        - `Custom Range`: Specify individual slide numbers or ranges (e.g., "1, 3, 5-8").
    4. **Print Layout**: This is crucial for handouts.
        - `Full Page Slides`: Prints one slide per page, usually covering the entire page area. Good for detailed review.
        - `Notes Pages`: Prints one slide per page with speaker notes below it. Essential for presenters.
        - `Outline`: Prints only the text outline of your presentation.
        - **`Handouts`**: This is the most common option for audience distribution. You can choose how many slides appear per page (e.g., 1, 2, 3, 4, 6, 9 slides per page). The 3-slides-per-page option usually includes lines for audience notes.
    5. **Color**:
        - `Color`: Prints in full color (if your printer supports it).
        - `Grayscale`: Prints in shades of gray.
        - `Pure Black and White`: Prints only in black and white, no grays.
    6. **Other Settings (Depend on software/printer)**:
        - `Collated`/`Uncollated`: How multiple copies are ordered.
        - `Orientation`: `Portrait` or `Landscape`.
        - `Scaling`: `Scale to Fit Paper`, `Print Hidden Slides`.
    7. **Number of Copies**: Specify how many copies you want.

8. **Click `Print`**: Send the job to the printer.

Tips for Printing Presentations:

- **Handouts for Audience**: Always consider printing handouts (e.g., 3 or 6 slides per page) for your audience so they can follow along and take notes.
- **Notes Pages for Presenter**: Print notes pages if you rely on speaker notes during your presentation.
- **Review Print Preview**: Always check the print preview before printing to ensure everything looks as expected and to avoid wasting paper/ink.
- **PDF for Distribution**: For digital distribution, converting the presentation to PDF is often better than sharing the .pptx file, as it preserves formatting and doesn't require the recipient to have the software.